

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

TikTok users bracing for ban

Small businesses, content creators in city fear fallout

By Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

Andrew Zavelson, clad in a plaid shirt and blue jeans, stands inside Chicago Vintage Posters, panning over some of the Lower West Side gallery's colorful designs for his TikTok feed. On the wall hangs everything from an Indiana Jones movie poster to an ad for a Quebec cruise.

"Please stop in today because these posters look so much better in person than they do online, and I think you'll agree once you come in to our gallery," he says into a phone camera while a "nostalgic waltz" plays in the background.

It was the second video Zavelson, the store's owner, ever posted to TikTok, and it went viral. More than 208,000 people viewed the August post, and comments such as "this was so endearing" and "This is perfect. I'm about to decorate my first Chicago apartment, you will be seeing me soon" flooded in.

The effect of that post was more than just online notoriety, Zavelson said. He soon had more people — especially young people — shopping at his gallery.

The fate of the popular app now hangs in the balance. On Friday, the Supreme Court will hear arguments over a law requiring TikTok to break ties with its Chinese-based parent company, ByteDance, or face a U.S. ban. Creators

Turn to *TikTok*, Page 5

Safety film feather in city's cap

Bird deaths plunge at Lakeside Center

By Nara Schoenberg
Chicago Tribune

For more than 40 years, migrating birds have been crashing into McCormick Place Lakeside Center.

The glassy, low-lying convention building on the shores of Lake Michigan has been the scene of about 1,000 deadly collisions per year, according to Dave Willard, retired Field Museum bird division collections manager.

In 2023, the death toll for a single day was so high — at least 960 birds — that the carnage became national news.

But this fall, when bird collision monitors performed their usual daily searches of the building's grounds, they found something remarkable: just 18 dead birds.

"To me, it was almost miraculous," said Willard.

The initial results are in

Turn to *Birds*, Page 4

JIMMY CARTER 1924-2024

At his funeral inside Washington National Cathedral, the 39th president was remembered by friends, family and statesmen as a politician for the people. Those at the extraordinary gathering, which temporarily suspended a cloud of hyperpartisanship over the nation's capital, praised the small-town Georgia native as someone who 'waged peace anywhere in the world.'

A life of service



By Bill Barrow and Chris Megerian | Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Former President Jimmy Carter was celebrated Thursday for his personal humility and public service before, during and after his presidency in a funeral at Washington National Cathedral featuring the kind of pageantry the 39th U.S. president typically eschewed. All of Carter's living successors were in attendance, with President Joe Biden, the first sitting senator to endorse Carter's 1976 run for the White House, delivering a eulogy. Biden and others took turns praising Carter's record — which many historians have appraised more favorably since losing his bid for a second term in 1980 — and extolling his character.

"He built houses for people who needed homes," said Joshua Carter, a grandson who recalled how Carter regularly taught Sunday school in his native hamlet of Plains, Georgia, after leaving the White House. "He eliminated diseases in forgotten places. He waged peace anywhere in the world, wherever he saw a chance. He loved people."

Jason Carter, another grandson, praised his grandfather and his wife, Rosalynn, who died in 2023. He wryly noted the couple's frugality, such as washing and reusing Ziploc bags, and the former president's struggles with his cellphone.

Turn to *Carter*, Page 2

Military members carry the flag-draped casket bearing the remains of former President Jimmy Carter from Washington National Cathedral following his state funeral Thursday as current and former presidents, first ladies and vice presidents stand in mourning. **CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY**

A DAY OF MOURNING: A look at funeral services for Carter through the photographer's lens. **Nation & World inside Business, Page 8**



A person walks with a bicycle amid the destruction left behind by the Palisades Fire on Tuesday in the Pacific Palisades neighborhood of Los Angeles. **JAEC. HONG/AP**

PROGRESS MADE: Firefighters aided by calmer winds saw the first signs of beating back a series of deadly wildfires Thursday, though they still burned out of control in and around Los Angeles as the scale of destruction came into view. **Nation & World**

'I just didn't know how fast things could spread'

Chicagoans in LA flee deadly blazes

By Carolyn Stein and Peter Breen
Chicago Tribune

Danielle Ryan woke up from her nap on Tuesday around 11 a.m. to multiple missed calls and messages from loved ones telling her to get out of her home in the Pacific Palisades. It was not until the Chicago native opened her blinds and saw orange smoke erupting close to where she lived when she finally understood why. With very little time, Ryan grabbed a few essential items — her passport,

computer, medication, dog food and dog — and drove off to a friend's house in Calabasas. She initially started driving north on Sunset Boulevard only to find the area backed up with cars, so she turned around and started going south, passing pedestrians helping others trying to escape.

"I'm just trying to just stay calm, stay focused, drive, get out of there," Ryan said. "But just out my rearview mirror, I'm seeing just the smoke around all the fires."

Although she was aware of how dangerous wildfires could be in California, Ryan — who moved to LA last

Turn to *Fires*, Page 4

Record Illinois sign-ups for ACA

A record number in Illinois have signed up for Affordable Care Act plans for this year — amid uncertainties about the future of tax credits that lower costs. **Business**

Search could hinge on Williams

Maximizing quarterback Caleb Williams' growth in his second season will be a "huge factor" in the Bears' search for a new head coach, the team says. **Chicago Sports**

'The Brutalist' meets its destiny

The tale of immigration and architecture is many things: some blunt, others loose and dangling, still others richly provocative, most of them remarkable. **Review in A+E**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 30 Low 19

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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